Employee Code of Conduct & Workplace Ethics Policy

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DOCUMENT CONTROL & GOVERNANCE SUMMARY

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Policy Owner:	Head of Employee Relations & H…	**Next Review:**	2027-01-01
Approver:	Executive Board / Chief Human…	**Version:**	v1.0
Scope / Audience:	All Full-Time, Probationary,…	**Classification:**	Internal Policy

1. LEGAL DISCLAIMER & CODE OF CONDUCT PREAMBLE

Please note: This free template policy is for informational purposes only and does not constitute formal legal advice. It is a corporate governance template designed to align with Acas legal frameworks, POSH statutory regulations, and international business ethics standards. Organizations customizing this document should seek qualified legal counsel.

Our Organization is committed to sustaining an ethical, respectful, and dignified work culture. This policy sets out mandatory standards of professional conduct, workplace decorum, non-discrimination, anti-harassment, conflict of interest, intellectual property protection, and progressive disciplinary governance across all operating entities.

2. PROFESSIONAL DEMEANOR, ETHICS & ANTI-DISCRIMINATION STANDARDS

1.1 Professional Demeanor & Integrity:
Employees must uphold the highest standards of honesty, integrity, professional decorum, courtesy, and mutual respect in all interactions with colleagues, clients, vendors, and business partners.

1.2 Diversity, Equity & Non-Discrimination:
The Organization maintains zero tolerance for discrimination, bias, or harassment based on race, color, gender, age, religion, national origin, disability, sexual orientation, or marital status.

1.3 Workplace Attire Standards:
Business casual attire is required Monday through Thursday; smart casual attire is permitted on Fridays.

3. PROTECTION OF INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY, SOURCE CODE & TRADE SECRETS

2.1 Data & IP Confidentiality:
All proprietary source code, software architectures, customer records, strategic financial models, employee PII, and trade secrets remain strictly confidential during and post-employment.

2.2 Public Representation & Media Ban:
Employees are forbidden from speaking to media outlets, making public statements, or publishing corporate information on social media without explicit written authorization from Corporate Communications.

4. PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT (POSH) & 90-DAY ICC SLA

3.1 Zero-Tolerance Mandate:
Absolute zero tolerance for physical, verbal, non-verbal unwelcome advances, sexually colored remarks, hostile work environment creation, or quid pro quo demands.

3.2 Internal Complaints Committee (ICC):
A statutory ICC headed by a senior female leader conducts confidential, independent inquiries into POSH complaints within a 90-day statutory SLA.

3.3 Whistleblower Anti-Retaliation Immunity:
Complainants and witnesses receive absolute immunity against retaliation, intimidation, or adverse employment action.

5. CONFLICT OF INTEREST, ANTI-BRIBERY & ABSOLUTE MOONLIGHTING BAN

4.1 Absolute Moonlighting Prohibition:
Employees shall not engage in secondary paid employment, commercial freelancing, consulting, or side businesses during active employment without prior written approval from the Chief Executive Officer.

4.2 Gifts & Corporate Hospitality Threshold:
Soliciting or accepting cash, gifts, or lavish entertainment from business contacts exceeding ¹2,000 / $25 in value is strictly prohibited. Any unsolicited gift exceeding this limit must be declared to HR Operations within 48 hours.

6. PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINARY ACTION MATRIX & PENALTIES

Conduct infractions trigger progressive stage-wise penalties:
• Stage 1 (Minor Infractions): Informal Counseling & Recorded Verbal Warning.
• Stage 2 (Repeated Breaches): Official Written Reprimand Letter placed in personnel file.
• Stage 3 (Severe Misconduct): Suspension without Pay (up to 14 days) or placement on a 30-60 day Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).
• Stage 4 (Gross Misconduct / Theft / Harassment): Summary Dismissal / Termination of Employment accompanied by civil or criminal prosecution.

7. GRIEVANCE & APPEALS SLA FRAMEWORK

Employees wishing to appeal a conduct penalty may log a formal written grievance with the HR Appeals Panel within 7 working days of notice. The panel conducts an independent review and issues a final binding decision within 14 working days.

VERSION CONTROL & REVISION HISTORY

Version 1.0 (Effective Date: 2026-01-01)

Author: Employee Relations | Approved By: CHRO | Summary: Comprehensive corporate code of conduct, POSH anti-harassment, and ethics framework release